

Revelation 1:12-16 (RSV)
The vision of Christ ... “I turned to see the Voice”

Then I turned to see the voice
that was speaking to me,
and on turning I saw seven golden lampstands,
and in the midst of the lampstands
one like a son of man,
clothed with a long robe
and with a golden girdle round his breast;
his head and his hair were white as white wool,
white as snow;
his eyes were like a flame of fire,
his feet were like burnished bronze,
refined as in a furnace,
and his voice was like the sound of many waters;
in his right hand he held seven stars,
from his mouth issued a sharp two-edged sword,
and his face was like the sun shining in full strength.

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When I saw him,
I fell at his feet as though dead.
But he laid his right hand upon me,
saying, "Fear not,
I am the first and the last,
and the living one;
I died, and behold
I am alive for evermore,
and I have the keys of Death and Hades.

Now write what you see,
what is and
what is to take place hereafter.

As for the mystery of the seven stars
which you saw in my right hand,
and the seven golden lampstands,
the seven stars are the angels of the seven churches
and the seven lampstands are the seven churches.